

Shibuya timelapse video

A look at the sea of humanity that crosses the roads at Shibuya and how quickly the roads clear up as well
<http://goo.gl/s6pRj>



Maid Cafe culture

Maid Cafes in Tokyo cater to Otakus, but there's much more behind this subculture. Read on:
<http://goo.gl/0ku0P>



1) Popularly known as the Times Square of Tokyo, Shibuya is famous for its signal crossing; 2) We got adventurous and tried the Octopus sushi, it tasted like a stiffer version of squid; 3) Otakus or nerds outside the electronics megamall Akihabara engrossed in gaming. Notice how they're neatly standing against the corner of the pavement; 4) Vending machines are as common in Tokyo as paan shops in India. You'll find one at every street corner. There are over 5 million of them in Japan; 5) Looks tempting doesn't it? You'll come across many such imitation food displays outside Japanese restaurants. It's an art form in itself (Pictures: Nimish Sawant)

characters with elaborate makeup. On both sides of the street are shops, some selling simple desserts and clothes while others selling wilder items. If you happen to be in Tokyo, this is one place that deserves a visit to just get a feel of the teen culture here. You will find it right opposite the Harajuku metro station.

Speaking of metro stations, the Tokyo rail network is one of the most elaborate networks we've ever come across. We, the travellers of the famed Mumbai locals. While it's difficult for outsiders from

Mumbai to get their heads around three lines, imagine our dilemma as we had to make sense of around 13 lines dotted with 274 stations! But worry not, with the Tokyo subway map, you're good to go and you will always find a good samaritan to help you out. We encountered two such samaritans on two days. And if you miss the Mumbai rush hour, head to Shinjuku metro station which is packed to the gills with people during the Tokyo rush hour. Saving the best for the last – Akihabara, the mecca of electronics in Tokyo.

The Yodobashi Akiba building in this district has seven floors filled with electronic items. Each floor is categorised and you won't see such variety in products anywhere else. So be prepared to spend hours here.

And don't forget to check out the maid cafes which cater to the Japanese nerds also known as "Otaku". After a week full of camera extravaganza and introduction to Japanese culture, it was disheartening to bid Sayonara to the land of the rising sun. 